Tianyang Zhou

tz64@illinois.edu | qsdrqs.github.io
github.com/qsdrqs | LinkedIn | Google Scholar

Education

- **Ph.D. in Computer Science** Aug 2023 – Present
  University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Illinois, USA
  - ◇ Research Area: Program Translation, Software Security
  - ◇ Advisors: Varun Chandrasekaran, Kirill Levchenko
- **M.S. in Computer Engineering** Sep 2021 – Jun 2023
  University of California, San Diego, California, USA
  - ◇ Advisor: Deian Stefan
- **B.E. in Software Engineering** Sep 2017 – Jun 2021
  Xi'an Jiaotong University, Shaanxi, China

Selected Publications

- **Verifiers in the Loop: Decoding Time Verification for Code Translation**
  Tianyang Zhou, Somesh Jha, Mihai Christodorescu, Kirill Levchenko, Varun Chandrasekaran.
  Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2026. arXiv:2605.17626
  - ○ Built a decoding-time verification framework that catches translation errors on-the-fly via compilation, lint, and test oracles.
  - ○ Demonstrated cross-language generalizability with end-to-end evaluation on C-to-Rust and JS-to-TS pipelines.
- **SoK: Understanding (New) Security Issues Across AI4Code Use Cases**
  Qilong Wu*, Taoran Li*, **Tianyang Zhou***, Varun Chandrasekaran.
  **Equal Contribution* arxiv:2512.18456
  - ○ Led the code translation section, focusing on security impact of LLM-based translation and robustness during translation.
  - ○ Co-authored taxonomy and analysis shaping 13 research questions and 11 future directions.
- **SACTOR: LLM-Driven Correct and Idiomatic C to Rust Translation with Static Analysis and FFI-Based Verification**
  Tianyang Zhou, Ziyi Zhang, Haowen Lin, Somesh Jha, Mihai Christodorescu, Kirill Levchenko, Varun Chandrasekaran.
  Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) 2026. NeurIPS Workshop DL4C 2025. 2026.acl-long.28
  - ○ Designed and implemented a two-phase LLM with static analysis pipeline for C-to-Rust translation.
  - ○ Built FFI-based verification harness enabling scalable end-to-end equivalence testing across translation stages.
- **Fine-grained Library Sandboxing for Rust Ecosystem**
  Tianyang Zhou.
  Master's Thesis, University of California, San Diego. 2023. ProQuest
  - ○ Built a Rust framework to sandbox libraries so Rust can safely call C APIs via FFI.
  - ○ Designed developer-friendly interfaces minimizing code modifications to adopt the framework.

Technical Skills

- **Programming:** C, C++, Rust, Python
- **Security/PL Skills:** LLVM/Clang, Program Analysis, Fuzzing, Sanitizers
- **ML for Code:** Transformers, LLM Fine-tuning, Verifier-in-the-loop, Agentic Workflows

Professional Experience

- **SWE Intern @ Google SRG (SystemsResearch@Google)** May 2026 - Aug 2026
  - ○ Developed spec-driven LLM agent workflows for system software construction, targeting hypervisor components.
- **Invited Talk @ Google Research** May 2025
  - ○ SACTOR: LLM-Driven Multi-Step Translation from C to Rust using Static Analysis.

Academic Service

- **NeurIPS 2026**, *Reviewer*; recognized as a **Top Reviewer**